



white-ball. The standard has really gone up," the fast bowler adds.

Pandit, who has worked with multiple teams, notes that playing more cricket — whether red-ball or white-ball — has significantly helped players gain a deeper understanding of the game. "This wasn't the case earlier. And having played in the IPL or other competitions, young players have had the opportunity to

rub shoulders with international cricketers, giving them the confidence to perform well in domestic tournaments," Pandit says.

"Twenty or 30 years ago, we only had the Ranji Trophy, but with T20s, players have gained a lot of experience, and they bring that experience, skill set, and mindset to red-ball cricket, which makes things exciting," he adds.

Ending a drought: Madhya Pradesh claimed the Ranji Trophy 2021-22 title, triumphing 69 years after its previous victory, then as Holkar, and 23 years since it last contended for this prestigious accolade in Indian domestic cricket. K. MURALI KUMAR